

HISTORICAL MARKER NOMINATION FORM

1. Subject of Marker / Marker Title
State name of person (include birth and death dates), event, or site to be commemorated.

Lincoln Highway / Lincoln Highway 1913-1927

2. Please use the space below to provide a historical overview and specify fully the historical significance of the person, event, or site. **Be sure to explain why this marker will have meaning for people from the whole state or country, not just from your own community. If of broader significance, be sure to describe the subject's Pennsylvania connection.** Be concise. Do not exceed the space provided.

The Lincoln Highway was the first transcontinental route to extend from the Atlantic to the Pacific across the United States connecting New York and San Francisco. The original route was developed and dedicated in 1913, spanning significant portions of Pennsylvania from east to west for approximately 300 miles. The original 1913-1927 route followed the pre-colonial Native American trail known as the Great Path along the Ohio River through Beaver County, PA. (Butko, 280). The Lincoln Highway brought travelers from Pittsburgh through the towns of Sewickley, Ambridge, Conway, Freedom, Rochester, Beaver, and several other villages and industrial towns along this portion of the road until reaching the "Point of Beginning" at the PA-OH border at Ohioville, PA where the route continued westward through 9 more states until reaching Lincoln Park in San Francisco, CA.

The establishment of the Lincoln Highway was a significant event in the national road building movement and preceded the development of a national highway system. Few reminders of the historic route mark the landscape in Western Pennsylvania. Yet the creation of this trans-national highway played a critical role in changing the way Americans traveled by exemplifying the possibilities and benefits of the automobile and to a greater extent the American spirit, thus paving the way to prosperity for many towns across Pennsylvania as well as the nation.

3. Please provide a draft of the text for the marker. (Note: A final text will be written in collaboration with PHMC staff.)

The Lincoln Highway, the first transcontinental highway in America, at its inception marked the beginning of the age of automobiles. Established in 1913 in honor of Abraham Lincoln, the original route traversed Pennsylvania approximately 300 miles from Morrisville, PA to Ohioville, PA. At Pittsburgh, the 1915 route followed roads built along the Native American trail known as the "Great Path" near the Ohio River to the state border and continued westward to San Francisco until the route was changed in 1927. This marker recognizes the end of the Lincoln Highway in Pennsylvania for westbound travelers and a new beginning in auto travel in America.

4. Are you requesting a city type marker (27" x 41½", approx. 40 words, approx. cost \$1350.00) or a roadside type marker (45¼" x 45 ¾", approx. 70 words, approx. cost \$1800.00)?

☒ **Roadside type**

☐ City type

5. Bibliographical data — From what publications can further information be secured to understand the historical background, to evaluate historical significance, and to prepare a proper marker text? If you wish to provide additional sources of information, feel free to attach a list, utilizing the format below for referencing them.

If completing this form as a Word document, you may delete the underlines or type over them using the "insert" key on your computer keyboard.

Author: **Butko, Brian A.**

Title: **Pennsylvania Traveler's Guide to the Lincoln Highway**

Date & Publisher: **Stackpole Books, Mechanicsburg, PA (1996)**

Author: **Lincoln Highway Association**

Title: **The Complete official Guide to the Lincoln Highway, 5th Ed.**

Date & Publisher: **Patrice Press, Tucson AZ, (1993)**

Supporting Documentation - Attach copies of excerpts from essential published or unpublished primary or secondary source material. This material should support the overview you have written, and verify your claims.

6. Describe the suggested marker site. Are there any surviving features, built or topographical, that relate to the proposed commemoration? (While survival of such features is not a determining factor in the approval of markers, a suggested marker should be close enough to the site described to take advantage of any features that do survive. It should also be located so as to maximize visibility and accessibility to the public.) If possible, please attach a photograph. The final location will be subject to PHMC approval.

The suggested marker would be located in an existing public park to be intersected by the proposed Ohio River Trail in Ohioville, PA near the historic "Point of Beginning".

7. Provide information on suggested marker site:

County: **Beaver**

Street address or intersection (town or city location): (*"325 Main St." or "southwest corner of Main and Oak Streets"*)

Lock 57 Park at intersection of Calcutta Rd and Route 68 (Midland Rd.)

City: **Ohioville**

Highway route number (for locations other than city streets): ("PA 322") PA Route 68

Nearest town and distance in miles: ("2 miles east of Centerville") Ohioville

If not a highway, identify closest highway route and give approximate distance from it:
(".5 miles south of Pa. 6")

If the marker is suggested for placement inside a park, specify exact location within the park: ("Adjacent to gazebo in Memorial Park; along Main Street side of park")

Adjacent to shelter in Lock 57 Park, Ohioville Pa

8. Please provide information on yourself as preparer of this form:

Name: **Dr. Vincent Troia**

Address: **1100 Pennsylvania Av**

City: **Monaca** State: **Pa.** Zip: **15061-1830**

Telephone: **(724) 728-2625**

Fax Number: **(724) 775-9876**

E-mail address: **drvtrioia@ohiorivertrail.org**

If you are writing on behalf of an organization, please indicate your title and the name of the organization ("President, Eastern Historical Society"). While an individual may prepare a nomination, a non-profit organization, local government, or educational institution must be identified as sponsoring organization to receive a matching grant.

CEO, Ohio River Trail Council (www.ohiorivertrail.org)

Your signature: _____

Submission date: **November 29, 2011**

Pennsylvania Historical Marker Nomination Form

Please submit your nomination (pages 5 to 8 only) without using cover, page protectors, bindings, and other “presentation” materials.

Return twelve (12) copies of your completed nomination form including any additional supporting material, collated into twelve (12) complete packets for distribution to evaluators, to:

Historical Marker Program
Pennsylvania Historical and Museum Commission
Bureau for Historic Preservation
400 North Street, 2nd Floor
Harrisburg, PA 17120-0093

If you have any questions about completing this form, please contact Karen Galle at (717) 705-4266, or via email at: kgalle@state.pa.us.

If you are deaf, hard of hearing, or speech impaired and wish to contact a hearing person via Text Telephone, you may use the PA Relay Center at 1-800-654-5984.